

SIG Unified grammar configuration file format - John
scribe: Dan

John: overview (see slides)

Emily: Can we express choice of two out of three candidate systems (e.g. ACE and PET but not LKB)?

John: Might need extension to existing expressivity to allow disjunction of values

John: Need to change ACE to expect double-quotes for preprocessor-modules values
(because dots cause trouble with reader)

Same for irregular-forms.

Also, discard lkb/noparse-rules.set

Emily: Will want to propagate this normalization to Matrix, once it stabilizes.

John: Current duplication in how parse-node labels are identified

Maybe adopt :label alongside :type and :instance values

John: Move creation of erg.hds to post-load lisp file, rather than current form

Emily: Would be hard to arrive at principled way of computing head dtr in Matrix so won't do it for now.

Spencer: On computing head dtr for Matrix, could we just leave out the non-headed phrases?

Emily: It would be an incomplete solution, and hard to explain to grammarian,
so instead consider presenting this facility as an option, but not automatic.

John: Since order of execution matters, the grammarian might choose to reorder
statements in config file to reflect the order the LKB has to impose in loading.

John: Parameters currently set in globals.lsp and mrsglobals.lsp could maybe be
moved to config file, but not all are relevant to ACE, so how to retain good
feedback (say for typos of parameter names) to grammarian while also noting
irrelevance for ACE.

John: Need to order loading in english.tdl so types are all defined before instances. Can add a meta-
warning message upon loading to advise grammarian of these constraints on loading order.

John: Note that parse-nodes file is being loaded twice for ACE: once in config
and once in english.tdl. Should just do once.

John: Summarizing --

Can accommodate conditions on system settings, just a little verbose.

Do we need to support setting of a parameter with no value given? Maybe look for a parameter
whose default value would not be empty but may not be what the grammarian wants.

Mike: Thanks, John, for forward movement. One additional benefit of normalizing is to highlight
where processors are not fully aligned. Want consistent results across processors for a given input
with same configuration.

- The hack of skipping over blocks of :begin ... ACE and :end would fail if there is nesting. [John agrees].

- For empty value for a parameter, need to know something about how the value will be interpreted.

John: On interpreting values, may have to do some work to interpret the value for a parameter, e.g. for chart-dependencies, where get a list of features missing the connecting dots for the feature path.

Mike: Can make Pydelphin conform to what LKB is doing now.

John: Mike, what about disjunctions (and conjunctions) of processor names? e.g. :lkb and :singlish - how best to express those in the config file?

Mike: Didn't want to provide boolean logic in config statements. Maybe instead use nesting for conjunction.

Emily: And treat the list of values as disjunction.

John: Repetition to be treated as reassignment, not conflict. Can add warning upon reassignment.

John: Values to be treated as case-insensitive, no hyphens or underscores.